

The 1986 FIFA World Cup final was the final of the 1986 FIFA World Cup, held in Mexico. The match was held at the Estadio Azteca in Mexico City on 29 June 1986 and had an attendance of 114,600. It was contested by Argentina and West Germany. Argentina won the match 3–2 in regulation time.

Route to the final

Match

Summary

José Luis Brown opened the scoring for Argentina in the 23rd minute with a header resulting from an error of West Germany goalkeeper Toni Schumacher on a free-kick from the right and it stayed at 1–0 until half-time. 11 minutes into the second half, Jorge Valdano doubled Argentina's lead with a low side foot finish after cutting in from the left past the advancing goalkeeper. Karl-Heinz Rummenigge pulled a goal back in the 74th minute from close range for West Germany, his first goal in the tournament. West Germany then equalised in the 81st minute, with Rudi Völler scoring with a header from close range. Although Diego Maradona was heavily marked by Lothar Matthäus throughout the game, his pass to Jorge Burruchaga in the 84th minute allowed Argentina to regain the lead at 3–2 when he slid the ball past the advancing goalkeeper from the right and into the corner of the net.

Six yellow cards were issued in this match, which was a record number until the 2010 FIFA World Cup Final. Two of them were issued because of timewasting from Argentine players. As the clock expired, Argentina celebrated their second World Cup victory in three tournaments after having won the 1978 World Cup on home soil.

Details

Aftermath

The second World Cup won by Argentina is regarded by many as the most important victory

for an Argentine side. Four years later, both teams met in the final of the 1990 World Cup, with West Germany winning. This marked the first time two World Cup finalists met twice, a record later shared with Brazil and Italy, the 1970 and 1994 World Cup finalists. Argentina and Germany met in the 2014 final for a record third time as finalists.

With the 1986 defeat, German manager Franz Beckenbauer gained the distinction of having lost a World Cup final as a player (in 1966) and a manager. In 1990 he managed Germany to victory, becoming a winner of the World Cup as player (in 1974) and as manager.

The games are won by the players on the field, but behind it there must be a machinery that works. There I include players, coaching staff and leaders. If you all pull in the same direction, you can think of titles. That's what happened in Mexico '86.

Germany won their fourth title in 2014. Argentina would not see another world title for 36 years until their win over France in the 2022 final.

The pitch of the Azteca stadium would not see another World Cup match until the 2026 opening between co-host Mexico and South Africa.

See also

[Argentina at the FIFA World Cup](#)

[Germany at the FIFA World Cup](#)

References

Reports

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